

PC SOFTWARE



Mac OS

Mac fanboys might be ready to draw wands or whatever the hell it is they carry around the moment they hear someone diss their beloved OS or its 'creator'. It's true however that all of us have our favorites. The Mac OS X came from a Unix and a NeXTSTEP based background. As of August 2011 the Mac OS X has a share of about 7.31 percent in the OS market. After a number of years in tussle with Microsoft, Mac OS remains a niche favorite. What created a buzz in the OS market with its release treaded on a silent path later and exists in today only in a handful of machines. However Mac OS X has maintained itself over the years as a cool OS, something which is classy, incredible to look at and is cool to work with.



Torrent

Isn't it kind of surprising that a tiny little software which weighs a few KBs is capable of downloading several GBs of data. We're talking about the bit torrent client *utorrent*. *utorrent* has been in the foray of peer to peer protocol for quite some time now. With its more recent releases *utorrent* started offering legal content licensed under creative commons.



Nullsoft

Nullsoft's claim to fame is Winamp music player, apart from that the company has also created SHOUTcast MP3 which is a media streaming server. Nullsoft is basically a parody on Microsoft, its mascot is a south American sheep like animal known as a llama. Nullsoft's Winamp has been one of the most famous media players which has almost directed the way we consume our music.



Yahoo messenger

Talking about Yahoo messenger truly takes one down memory lane. It was one of the first tools that made social networking a reality. Back in the glory days of Yahoo messenger chat rooms used to be full with random ASL requests popping up every now and then. A whole chatting culture got evolved because of it. Personal and group chats became the fad of the season with specialized chat rooms coming into the picture. Initially released under the name of Yahoo pager in 1998 it brought with it concepts such as Buzzing, music status, avatars and integrated address books. Its currently in its 11th version.



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Indian IT employees are paid one fifth of a salary as compared to their US or European counterparts. This is also because of the fact that India produces a huge pool of English speaking graduates each year making it easier for IT companies to recruit in mass.



DivX

DivX comprises of two essential codecs – MPEG-4 Part 2 and H.264 MPEG-4. DivX as a codec has gained immense popularity in the past few years mainly due to its video compressing qualities while still maintaining high picture quality. It's one of the most preferred codecs to rip a particular file. French hacker Jerome Rota and his colleague reverse engineered a codec when a video refused to play in Windows Media Player, and the rest is history.



Quicktime

You might hate it or love it but you can't ignore the Quicktime player. Currently in its tenth avatar Quicktime supports about a handful of formats and requires additional components to play a variety of other codecs. Debuting in 1991 Quicktime's developers played the famous 1984 Apple ad on a Mac in Worldwide Developers Conference promoting it as a multimedia add-on for System Software 6.



Ubuntu

Ubuntu gets its name from a Southern African philosophy ubuntu, which mean humanity towards others. Its one of the most famous Linux distributions and is funded by Canonical. Ubuntu comes out with a new version every six month since 2004. There's long term release commitment with every fourth edition of Ubuntu which means that security patches and other bug issues would be resolved and updated by the Ubuntu team till the next fourth release.



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